



Placement and Residential Licensing Unit

P.O. Box 1437, Slot S140, Little Rock, AR 72203-1437

P: 501.682.8590 F: 501.683.6060 TDD: 501.682.1550

Notice of Serious Incident

Case Number: 020873

Date of Incident: 4/18/2024

Date Received: 4/18/2024

Facility Name: Perimeter Behavioral of Forrest City

Facility Number: 142

Incident Type: Licensing

Report Description: Licensing was included in a complaint to the Office of Long Term Care on 4/18/2024. Licensing has reviewed the complaint and will be accepting this as a complaint against Perimeter of Forrest City for Licensing investigation. The complaint states that during the review of three restraint holds at the facility by SAMA founder Larry Hampton and Executive Vice President Lisa Hampton comments were made about the inappropriate use of SAMA techniques by Perimeter staff.

Interim Action Narrative:

Maltreatment Narrative:

Licensing Narrative: 4/25/2024- After continued review of this report and consultation with DHS legal, licensing will be investigating this notification as a complaint against the facility. The program manager spoke to the CEO of Perimeter and requested an in person meeting to review the comments made by the SAMA foundation. CEO Charlotte Lockhart reported that she and her on site SAMA instructor will not both be available for a meeting with Licensing until May 7th. Licensing will visit the agency on May 7th to review the information and determine any corrective action, if needed. 5/7/2024- Program Manager and Licensing Specialist visited the agency and discussed the comments made regarding the restraint holds by the SAMA Program founder. The facility is currently in the process of

moving their behavior management program to Handle with Care and is approximately 85% complete with a goal completion date of July 1, 2024. Licensing will continue to monitor their progress with the change.



Division of Child Care & Early Childhood Education

P.O. Box 1437, Slot S140, Little Rock, AR 72203-1437

P: 501.508.8910 F: 501.683.6060 TDD: 501.682.1550

521 Visit Compliance Report

Licensee: Perimeter Behavioral of Forrest City

Facility Number: 142

Licensee Address: 603 KITTLE ROAD
FORREST CITY AR 72335

Licensing Specialist: Chelsea Vardell

Person In Charge:

Record Visit Date: 5/7/2024

Home Visit Date: 5/7/2024

Purpose of Visit: Complaint Visit

Regulations Out of Compliance:

Regulations Needing Technical Assistance:

Regulation Not Applicable:

Regulations Not Correctable:

Narrative:

Program Manager Chelsea Vardell and Licensing Specialist Eleanor White visited the facility and met with facility management to include Charlotte Lockhart, Clifton Williams, and Immanuel Morris.

Program Manager explained to the facility that responses regarding three incidents involving restraint holds were received by licensing. The responses quoted by SAMA founder and SAMA Executive Vice President were read aloud to the management team and discussed. Video of each of the restraint hold was also reviewed again with them. Two of the three incident were already previously addressed with the facility by licensing staff. The third incident was not reportable to licensing as it did not result in emergency medical care or an arrest, therefore it was not received by licensing until this complaint was filed.

The facility SAMA instructor, Cliff Williams, responded to each of the statements made by the SAMA foundation regarding their restraint holds in the videos. Mr. Williams explained that the prone and supine positions are not taught in SAMA and staff are trained to not use those positions. Mr. Williams explained that staff are trained to approach a resident from behind, restraint the resident arms across their body, then lower them to the floor if necessary. While on the floor, the staff is trained to continue the restraint from behind the resident while laying on their side and keep the child on their side. Mr. Williams explained that when a resident is resisting and fighting staff this is a very difficult restraint to maintain. Mr. Williams stated that when the resident is resisting staff will often try to restrain the child on the floor to keep them from hurting themselves, others, or property. Mr. Williams states that staff do actively engage in verbal de-escalation while the child is in the restraint, but since the videos do not have audio, you cannot hear them doing so.

The facility is currently in the process of moving away from SAMA as their form of behavior management and restraint program. Approximately 85% of the current staff have already been trained on Handle with Care and the remaining 15% should be trained by July 1, 2024.

Licensing will continue to monitor the facility's progress of transitioning to Handle with Care.

Provider Comments:

CCL Staff Signature :

Date: 5/9/2024

Provider Signature :

Date: 5/9/2024



Division of Child Care & Early Childhood Education

P.O. Box 1437, Slot S140, Little Rock, AR 72203-1437

P: 501.508.8910 F: 501.683.6060 TDD: 501.682.1550

521 Visit Compliance Report

Licensee: Perimeter Behavioral of Forrest City

Facility Number: 142

Licensee Address: 603 KITTLE ROAD
FORREST CITY AR 72335

Licensing Specialist: Chelsea Vardell

Person In Charge: Immanuel Morris

Record Visit Date: 5/7/2024

Home Visit Date: 5/7/2024

Purpose of Visit: Special Visit

Regulations Out of Compliance:

Regulation Number: 900.905.9

Regulation Description: Physical restraints shall be performed using minimal force and time necessary. Physical restraint means the application of physical force without the use of any device, for the purposes of restraining the free movement of a resident's body. Briefly holding a child without undue force in order to calm or comfort, or holding a hand to safely escort a child from one area to another, is not considered a physical restraint.

Finding Description: Staff did not use the minimal force necessary during the course of a restraint hold.

Action Due Date:

Action Due Description: Staff has already been terminated from the facility due to a non related issue.

Comply Date:

Action Due Description: Staff has already been terminated from the facility due to a non related issue.

Regulations Needing Technical Assistance:

Regulation Not Applicable:

Regulations Not Correctable:

Narrative:

Licensing visited the facility in response to complaint case 020873. During the review of the video footage and in discussions with the facility management it was determined that the primary staff in the video initiating the restraint [REDACTED] did not use the minimal force necessary during this restraint hold. This is related to case 019214. The restraint hold referenced in this inspection occurred on 2/11/2024. The restraint was not reported to licensing as it did not meet criteria per standard 110.17, therefore licensing was not aware of any concerns with it at that time. The SAMA instructor for the facility, Mr. Williams, explained that when using SAMA the goal is to approach a resident from behind, position the residents' arms in a cross position in front of the resident's chest and only take them to the floor if it is necessary. However, when residents are combative or larger in size this position can be very difficult for staff to obtain and maintain until the resident is calm. In this incident the resident can be seen being combative prior to being taken to the floor by staff. Once on the floor the staff can be seen aggressively moving the resident around the floor in an attempt to obtain another position, then lays on top of the resident visibly putting his body weight on the resident.

The facility reviewed the comments made about this restraint by the SAMA founder and SAMA Executive Vice President. The facility reports that this staff member was already terminated due to another incident that occurred after this restraint. The other incident did not involve a restraint but did involve unprofessional conduct that does not meet the standard of care for the facility.

Due to the actions of the staff in the restraint hold the following standard is being cited.

905.9 failing to use the minimal force necessary during the course of a restraint hold.

Provider Comments:

CCL Staff Signature :

Date: 5/13/2024

Provider Signature :

Date: 5/13/2024